LOW-CODE DEVELOPMENT LABORATORY

EXPERIMENT 09

Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

Dashboard Insights, Conditional Formatting, and Kanban Analytics for the Loan Management System

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1. Aim

To examine the built-in analytics features of Zoho Creator, together with the AI-assisted capabilities offered through Zia, Zoho's AI assistant, by studying a dashboard, conditionally formatted reports and Kanban views of the Loan Management System, and to understand how these tools convert stored form data into clear visual insight without custom code.

2. Objectives

- Review the summary tiles and charts of the application dashboard, namely **Distribution by Loan Status** and **Distribution by Created By**.
- Study how conditional formatting colours the **Loan Status** and **Payment Status** values so that patterns can be read at a glance.
- Understand how Kanban report views (**Loan Status** and **Loan Types**) group records visually without any scripting.
- Examine the **All Loan Types** list report as the structured reference data on which these analytics rest.
- Recognise the role of Zia within Zoho Creator in suggesting chart types, assisting with dashboard layouts and surfacing patterns in application data.

3. Software and Tools Required

- Zoho Creator, the web-based low-code application development platform.
- The Loan Management System application.
- A web browser with an active internet connection.
- A Zoho account with access to the application in Access/Live mode.

4. Introduction and Theory

4.1 Built-In Analytics in Zoho Creator

Zoho Creator includes a set of analytics components that present form records as visual summaries, so no separate business-intelligence tool is needed. A dashboard page can bring together summary tiles, pie and bar charts and embedded reports in a single view. Individual reports can apply conditional formatting to colour rows or cells according to a field's value, and a Kanban report arranges records into columns based on a chosen field, giving a board-style picture of status or category.

Each of these components reads live data directly from the application's forms. As records are added or edited, the tiles, charts, colours and boards refresh on their own.

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4.2 Zia, Zoho's AI Assistant

Zia is the AI layer built into the Zoho ecosystem, and this includes Zoho Creator. Within Creator, Zia-driven features support the application builder in three ways: by suggesting a suitable chart type for a given report, by helping to generate a dashboard layout from existing forms, and by bringing out trends, for example which loan status or loan type occurs most frequently, that would otherwise require manual analysis.

Instead of hand-coding every chart, the builder can use these suggestions to move faster from a plain data table to a meaningful visual summary.

5. Key Concepts

The table below distinguishes the main components used in this experiment.

Concept	Description
Dashboard	A custom page that combines summary tiles, charts and embedded reports into one self-refreshing overview of the application's data.
Chart Widget	A visual element, such as a pie, bar or donut chart, linked to a report. It summarises records by a selected field, for instance Loan Status or Created By.
Conditional Formatting	A report-level rule that automatically colours a cell or row according to its value, so that exceptions such as Rejected applications or Overdue repayments stand out without manual checking.
Kanban Report	A board-style report that sorts records into columns by a selected field, for example Loan Status or Loan Type, allowing staff to scan records visually.
Zia Insights	AI-assisted suggestions within Zoho Creator that recommend chart types, help assemble dashboard layouts and point out patterns in the underlying data.

6. Application Specifications

The Loan Management System used in this experiment is described by the following parameters.

Parameter	Detail
Application Name	Loan Management System
Primary Forms	Borrower, Loan Application, Loan Type and Repayment
Dashboard Elements	Summary tiles for Total Borrowers, Total Loan Applications, Total Loan Types and Total Repayments; a Distribution by Loan Status pie chart; Quick Links; and a Distribution by Created By bar chart
Conditionally Formatted Reports	All Loan Applications (coloured by Status) and All Repayments (coloured by Payment Status)

Parameter	Detail
Kanban Reports	Loan Status (grouped into Pending, Approved, Rejected and Closed) and Loan Types (grouped by loan type under Loan Applications)
Master Data Report	All Loan Types, with the fields Loan Type Name, Code, Interest Rate, Maximum Amount, Tenure and Is Active

7. Procedure

The figures in this record are illustrative representations drawn with sample values. They are not screenshots of the application and do not display verified live data.

Step 1: Open and Review the Dashboard

The Loan Management System was opened, which loads its Dashboard. As soon as records exist, the dashboard condenses the underlying forms into tiles and charts, giving an overview of borrowers, applications, loan types and repayments in one place.

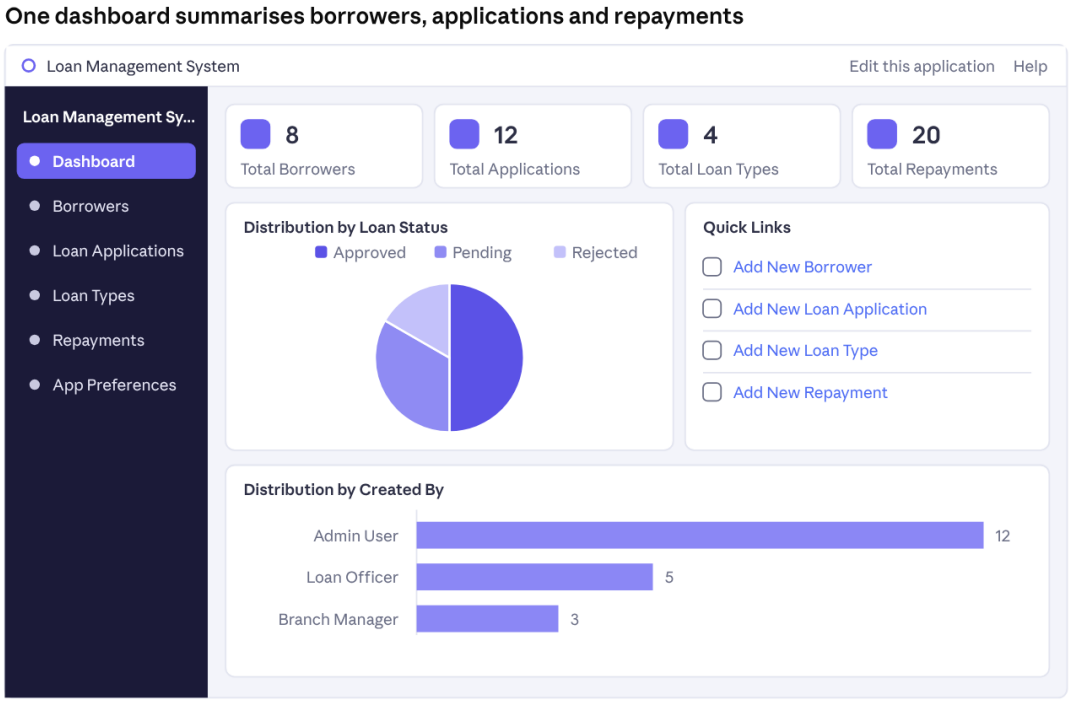


Figure 9.1: Dashboard - Summary Tiles and Charts (Illustrative Representation, Not a Screenshot)

> **Interpretation:** The dashboard presents four count tiles (Total Borrowers, Total Loan Applications, Total Loan Types and Total Repayments), a Distribution by Loan Status pie chart, a Quick Links panel, and a Distribution by Created By bar chart. All of these are generated directly from form data, with no manual charting.

Step 2: Inspect Conditional Formatting in All Loan Applications

Next, the All Loan Applications report was opened in order to observe how its Status column is colour-coded automatically according to the value held in each record.



Figure 9.2: All Loan Applications - Conditional Formatting by Status (Illustrative Representation, Not a Screenshot)

> **Interpretation:** Each Status cell is shaded by its value: green for Approved, blue for Pending and red for Rejected. A reviewer can scan the whole report and quickly pick out applications that need attention, instead of reading every row.

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Step 3: Examine the Loan Status Kanban View

The Kanban report named Loan Status was then selected. It arranges the loan application records into columns according to their Status field.

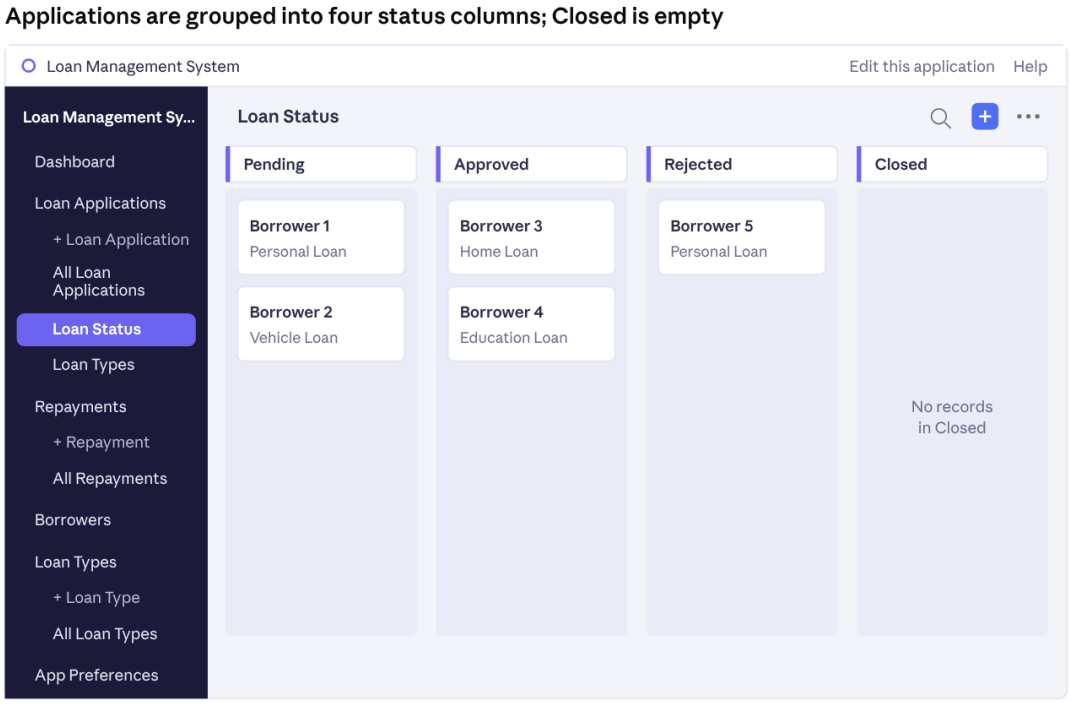


Figure 9.3: Loan Status - Kanban Report (Illustrative Representation, Not a Screenshot)

> **Interpretation:** The board contains four columns (Pending, Approved, Rejected and Closed), and each record appears as a card showing the borrower's name and a short note. A column with no records says so explicitly, so it is never ambiguous.

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Step 4: Review Conditional Formatting in All Repayments

The All Repayments report was opened next. Its Payment Status column applies the same conditional-colouring approach that was seen in the loan application report.

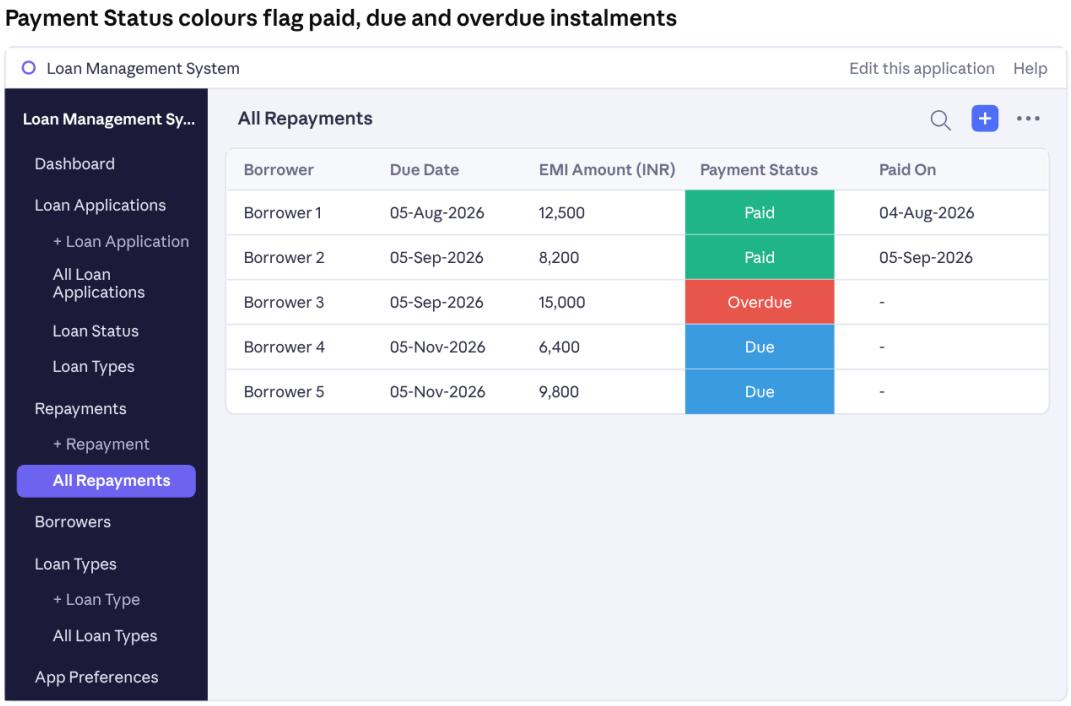


Figure 9.4: All Repayments - Conditional Formatting by Payment Status (Illustrative Representation, Not a Screenshot)

> **Interpretation:** Payment Status values are colour-coded: green for Paid, blue for Due and red for Overdue. This lets the collections team see at a glance which instalments still require action.

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Step 5: Inspect the All Loan Types Master Data

The All Loan Types report was opened to confirm the structured reference data, namely loan type codes, interest rates, limits and tenure, on which other analytics and lookups depend.

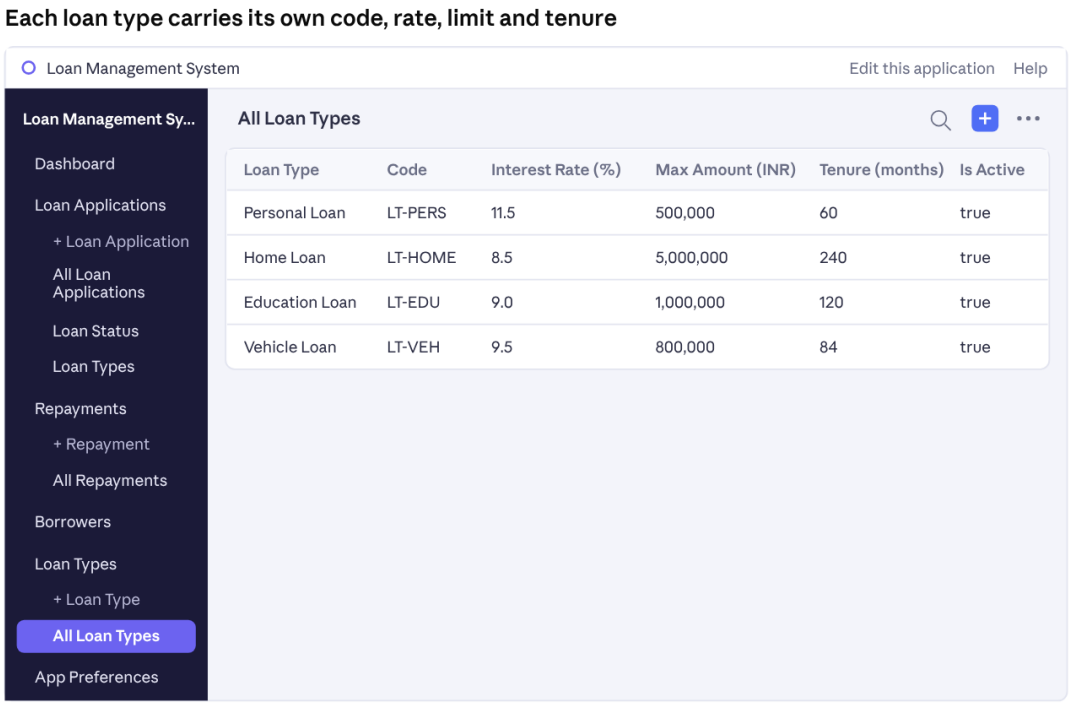


Figure 9.5: All Loan Types - Structured Reference Data (Illustrative Representation, Not a Screenshot)

> **Interpretation:** Every loan type is listed with its code, interest rate, maximum amount, tenure and active status. This forms the clean reference data that the dashboard and Kanban views ultimately summarise.

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Step 6: Examine the Loan Types Kanban View

Finally, the second Kanban report, Loan Types, was opened to see the loan applications grouped visually according to the type of loan.

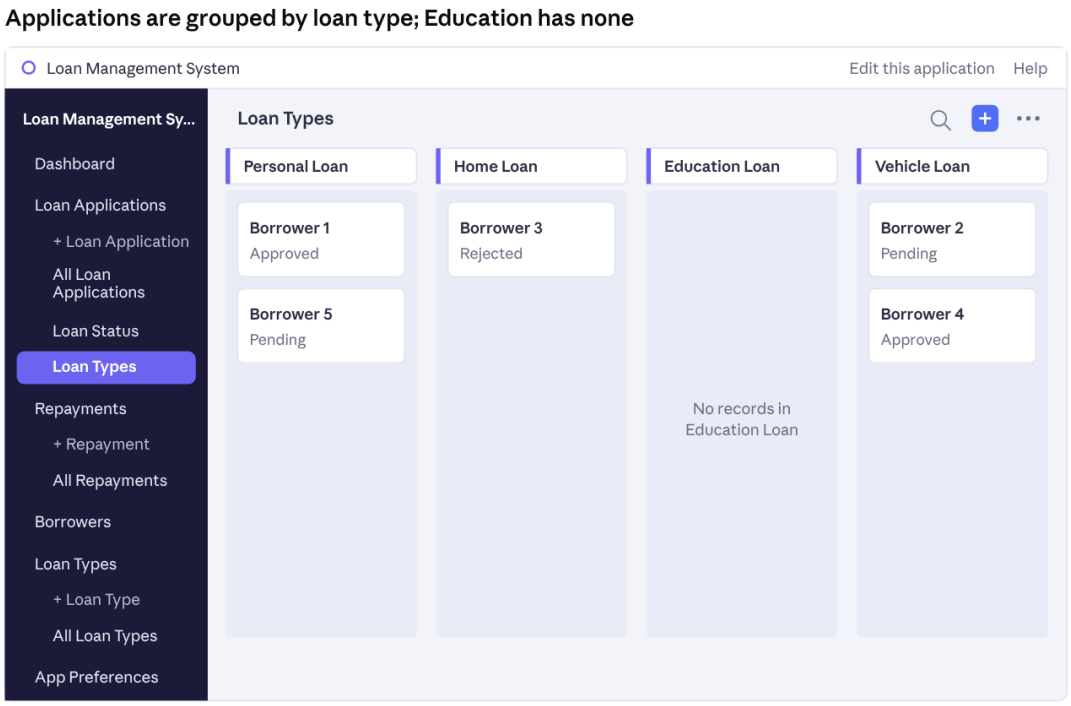


Figure 9.6: Loan Types - Kanban Report Grouped by Loan Type (Illustrative Representation, Not a Screenshot)

> **Interpretation:** Application cards are arranged into columns for Personal, Home, Education and Vehicle loans. Empty columns carry a "No records" label rather than being left blank, which keeps the board readable even when data is sparse.

8. Result

- The dashboard of the Loan Management System was reviewed, confirming that it summarises the application's forms into live tiles and charts without manual configuration.
- Conditional formatting was observed on two reports, All Loan Applications (by Status) and All Repayments (by Payment Status). In both, values are coloured automatically to highlight patterns.
- Two Kanban report views, Loan Status and Loan Types, were reviewed, confirming that records can be grouped and browsed visually by a chosen field.
- The All Loan Types report was reviewed as the structured reference data that underlies these analytics.

9. Conclusion

This experiment showed how the built-in analytics of Zoho Creator, supported by Zia-assisted features, turn plain form records into visuals that aid decision-making, without any custom charting code. The dashboard's tiles and charts offer an immediate overview of volume and distribution. Conditional formatting changes a flat table into a status map that is easy to scan, and Kanban reports let staff browse the same data as a visual board grouped by whichever field matters most, whether loan status, payment status or loan type.

Taken together, these features show that low-code analytics in Zoho Creator is not an add-on attached to the application afterwards. It is a natural extension of the structured forms and reports that were already built in earlier experiments.

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